

Design and Motion Playbook

Sep 26, 2026 · @Raghav Mahajan

The concept: "The Caravan Route"

The whole site becomes one journey: a dotted camel-caravan route that starts at the hero, winds down the page past each section like stops on a trip, and ends at the quote button. Every visual effect serves that one idea, so it feels designed, not decorated.

Look: outback freight meets modern Melbourne. Sand and kraft-cardboard textures, terracotta and deep navy, stencilled crate lettering, freight labels, real truck and crew photos. Warm, tactile, confident.

Feel: heavy things moving smoothly. Motion should feel weighted and deliberate, like a loaded truck pulling away, never bouncy or floaty. Short, purposeful, and always pointing the eye toward "Get a quote".

Three moments people should remember:

1. The hero: a real truck photo with a slow parallax, the headline stamping in like a freight label, and the price calculator already live.
2. The route: a line that draws itself as you scroll, with a tiny truck (or camel) riding along it.
3. The price: numbers that roll like an odometer when the home size changes, so the \$120/hour pricing feels alive and honest.

Everything else stays calm so those three moments land. That restraint is what separates "freaking awesome" from "AI template with too many animations".

Skill map

Use the skills as a pipeline in this order, and pick ONE lead aesthetic skill. Running every style skill at once is the fastest way to get a confused, generic result. The roles below are inferred from the skill names; skim each SKILL.md once so you know what it actually enforces.

Phase	Skill	What it does here
1. Understand	learn-codebase, smart-explore	Map the Next.js routes, components, Tailwind config and shadcn setup before touching anything
1. Understand	mem-search	Pull earlier decisions on this repo (CSP, admin route, forms) so the redesign does not break them
2. Audit	design-is (Dieter Rams audit)	Honest critique of the current site: what is useless, repeated, or decorative
2. Audit	agent-browser or claude-in-chrome	Screenshot current pages at 390px and 1440px as the "before"
3. Direction	redesign-existing-projects	Lead skill for the overall process, since this is a redesign not a new build
3. Direction	high-end-visual-design + design-taste-frontend	Lead aesthetic. Premium, editorial, considered
3. Direction	industrial-brutalist-ui (accents only)	Borrow stencil type, hard edges and freight-label details. Do not let it take over
4. Brand	brandkit	Lock the tokens: colours, type scale, spacing, radius, logo usage, texture
4. Brand	imagegen-frontend-web	ONLY for textures, the route line, map illustration, decorative stamps. Never for trucks, crew or jobs
5. Motion	design-motion-principles	Define the easing curves, durations and choreography in section 4 of this tab
6. Plan	make-plan	Turn this playbook into a step-by-step plan with checkpoints
7. Build	do + full-output-enforcement	Execute the plan, full files, no "rest stays the same" placeholders

Phase	Skill	What it does here
8. Polish	impeccable	Final pixel pass: spacing, alignment, states, typography details
9. Test	run + agent-browser	Run locally, screenshot every page at mobile and desktop, compare to "before"
10. Ship	simplify, code-review, security-review	Cut unused code, review, and make sure CSP, admin route and forms still hold
10. Ship	babysit	Watch the Vercel preview build and fix failures

Skip for this job: minimalist-ui (fights the warm, textured concept), gpt-taste and stitch-design-taste (a second lead aesthetic muddies the result), imagegen-frontend-mobile (the site is responsive web, not a native app), image-to-code (only useful if you sketch or find a reference layout you want matched), wowerpoint, dataviz.

Visual system

Keep the existing palette as the base and add depth, texture and real photography. These tokens go into Tailwind and CSS variables through the brandkit skill.

Colour tokens

Token	Hex	Use
sand-50	#faf7f0	Page background
sand-100	#f5efdd	Section background, cards
kraft-300	#c9a878	Texture tint, dividers, route line
terracotta-500	#d5673f	Primary CTA, highlights, the truck on the route
terracotta-700	#c1502e	CTA hover, links
navy-800	#1b3a5c	Headlines, dark sections
navy-950	#0b1b2e	Footer, hero overlay, dark mode base

Token	Hex	Use
ink-900	#232323	Body text
signal-400	#f99c00	Tiny accents only (freight stamp, "same-day" badge)

Rule: 70% sand, 20% navy, 10% terracotta. Terracotta is reserved for things you want clicked.

Typography

- **Display:** a slab or stencil-flavoured face for headlines. Shortlist to test: Zilla Slab, Roboto Slab, Bebas Neue for labels only, or a paid stencil face if the budget allows one font purchase.
- **Body/UI:** Barlow or Public Sans. Clean, slightly industrial, readable on phones.
- **Numbers:** tabular figures for every price and the calculator so digits do not jump when they animate.
- **Scale:** fluid with `clamp()`. Hero headline roughly 44px on mobile to 96px on desktop. Tight line-height (1.0 to 1.05) on headlines, 1.6 on body.
- **Freight labels:** small uppercase tracking-wide text in a bordered box ("LOAD 01 / HOUSE MOVES") as section eyebrows.

Texture and surfaces

- Subtle SVG grain over sand backgrounds (under 20 KB, 3 to 5% opacity).
- Kraft cardboard strip texture behind the fleet section.
- Hard 2px navy borders on key panels instead of soft shadows. Small corner radius (4px) so it feels like crates, not bubbles.
- One torn-paper or tape edge detail max per page. More than that turns into a scrapbook.

Photography

- 30 to 40 real photos from one shoot: both trucks from low angles, interior strapped loads, blankets and trolleys, crew faces, hands carrying furniture, a finished room.
- Consistent grade: warm, slightly lifted shadows, same across every photo so the site feels like one brand.

- Duotone treatment (navy + sand) for background photos behind text; full colour for featured photos.
- Every photo gets real alt text and a descriptive file name.

Icons and illustration

- Custom line icons in one stroke weight (drawn or commissioned), matching the route line style.
- A simple camel mark for the logo, designed by a person, not generated.
- Lucide only for UI (menu, phone, chevrons, close).

Components to rebuild

Header (transparent over hero, solid on scroll), hero with calculator panel, freight-label eyebrow, service row (photo + text, alternating), crew card, fleet card with "what fits" diagram, route line, suburb chips, FAQ accordion, quote stepper, sticky mobile action bar, footer.

Motion and effects spec

Three signature effects carry the site (hero stamp, scroll-drawn route, odometer prices); everything else is small and quick. Every effect has a reduced-motion fallback and must not delay the quote button or the phone number.

Tech choices

- **Motion (the `motion` / Framer Motion package)** for component entrances, hover states, layout animations, the calculator and page transitions.
- **GSAP + ScrollTrigger** for the scroll-drawn route line and the truck riding along it (GSAP is the most reliable for scroll-scrubbed SVG paths).
- **CSS only** for hovers, focus states, the header shrink and button presses. Cheapest option wins.
- **Page transitions:** the View Transitions API through Next.js/React if the installed version supports it; otherwise a Motion `AnimatePresence` fade in the layout. Check the version before choosing.
- **Smooth scrolling (Lenis):** optional. Test on a mid-range Android first. If it feels laggy or fights native scroll, drop it.

- Bundle everything locally so the existing CSP stays intact. No animation scripts from CDNs.

Motion tokens

Token	Value	Use
<code>ease-haul</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)</code>	Default entrance: fast start, heavy settle, like a truck braking
<code>ease-route</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(0.65, 0, 0.35, 1)</code>	Route line and anything travelling
<code>ease-stamp</code>	spring, stiffness 500, damping 30	The freight-stamp headline and badges
<code>dur-quick</code>	150 ms	Hovers, presses, toggles
<code>dur-base</code>	400 ms	Section entrances
<code>dur-hero</code>	700 ms	Hero sequence pieces
<code>stagger</code>	60 ms	Between items in a group, max 6 items
<code>distance</code>	16 to 24 px	Entrance travel. Never more; big slides feel cheap

Every effect, section by section

Where	Effect	How	Reduced motion
Page load	Hero photo fades from navy with a 1.04 to 1.0 scale settle	Motion, 700 ms, <code>ease-haul</code>	Instant, no scale
Hero headline	Words stamp in one by one: slight scale 1.08 to 1 with a tiny rotate, like a rubber stamp	Motion spring <code>ease-stamp</code> , 60 ms stagger	Plain fade

Where	Effect	How	Reduced motion
Hero photo	Slow parallax on scroll, photo moves at 0.85x scroll speed	CSS scroll-driven animation or Motion <code>useScroll</code>	Static
Calculator	Price digits roll like an odometer when the home size changes	Motion per-digit column animation, tabular figures	Number swaps instantly
Calculator	Truck size badge morphs 6t to 10t with a shared layout animation	Motion <code>layoutId</code>	Instant swap
Header	Transparent over hero, becomes solid sand with a hairline border and shrinks from 80 to 64 px after 80 px of scroll	CSS + a scroll listener or IntersectionObserver	Same, no transition
Route line	Dotted path draws down the page as you scroll, scrubbed to scroll position	GSAP ScrollTrigger on SVG <code>stroke-dashoffset</code>	Full line shown, static
Route truck	A small truck (or camel) icon rides the route line and pauses at each section "stop"	GSAP MotionPathPlugin	Hidden
Section eyebrows	Freight labels slide in 16 px and the border draws around them	Motion, 400 ms	Fade
Service rows	Photo reveals with a clip-path wipe (like a roller door opening upward), text follows 100 ms later	Motion <code>clipPath</code> inset animation	Fade
Crew strip	Photos go from duotone to full colour on hover/focus; names slide up	CSS filter + transform, 150 ms	Colour always on

Where	Effect	How	Reduced motion
Fleet cards	"What fits" icons (beds, couches, boxes) load into the truck outline one by one on scroll-in	Motion stagger 60 ms	All shown
Suburb chips	Tiny lift + terracotta underline on hover	CSS, 150 ms	Underline only
Buttons	Press scales to 0.97; primary CTA has a subtle moving-stripe (hazard tape) shimmer on hover	CSS, 150 ms	No shimmer
FAQ	Smooth height animation, plus icon rotates to a cross	Motion <code>AnimatePresence</code> + layout	Instant
Quote form	Steps slide horizontally with a progress route line filling at the top; success state stamps a "BOOKED IN" freight label	Motion, 400 ms	Fade
Page change	Cross-fade with the header and route line persisting	View Transitions API or <code>AnimatePresence</code>	None
Mobile bar	Slides up after the hero leaves the screen; hides when the footer is visible	IntersectionObserver + CSS transform	Always visible

What NOT to add

No custom cursors, no scroll-jacking, no particle backgrounds, no typewriter text, no 3D tilt cards, no infinite marquee of logos you do not have, no confetti, no autoplay video in the hero on mobile. These are the exact tells of template sites.

Page-by-page blueprint

The homepage drops from 11 sections to 9 by merging the repeats, and every section becomes a "stop" on the route line.

Homepage

Stop	Section	Layout	Signature detail
0	Hero	Full-bleed truck photo, navy overlay on the left third. Headline + one line + two buttons on the left, calculator panel overlapping the photo on the right (below the headline on mobile)	Stamped headline, odometer price, route line starts here
1	Proof strip	One thin row: ABN, 6t + 10t trucks, Cranbourne base, Google rating once real	Freight-label style tags
2	Services	Alternating rows: big photo one side, short copy + link other side. 6 services, not cards	Roller-door clip reveal
3	How it works	ONE merged version, 3 steps drawn as stops on a mini route, not numbered badges	Route line branches through it
4	Meet the crew	Horizontal strip of real faces with names and one line each	Duotone to colour on hover
5	The cameleer story	Dark navy section, archival-style 1860 treatment (sepia-toned map or engraving style illustration), 3 short paragraphs, then "same idea, bigger trucks"	The one place the camel appears large
6	Fleet	Two big truck photos side by side on kraft texture, each with a "what fits" outline diagram	Items load into the truck on scroll

Stop	Section	Layout	Signature detail
7	Where we move	Simple stylised map of the south-east corridor with Cranbourne pinned, suburb chips grouped by area	Pins drop in with a small stagger
8	FAQ + final CTA	FAQ on the left, big "Get your price in 60 seconds" panel on the right	Route line ends at the quote button

Removed or merged: the second "From booking to moving day" block (merged into stop 3) and "Why people choose us" (merged into proof strip + crew).

Inner pages

- **Pricing:** calculator front and centre, full-width, with an "invoice example" card showing the real maths line by line. Odometer numbers throughout.
- **Service pages:** photo hero specific to the service, 3 short sections, a worked price example, FAQ, 3 suburb chips, sticky "Get a quote for [service]" button.
- **Suburb pages:** header with suburb name in the display font and drive time from Cranbourne as a freight label ("15 MIN FROM DEPOT"), a local photo when one exists, local notes, recent job card, nearby suburbs as chips on a mini map.
- **About:** long-form editorial layout, the cameleer history with a timeline (1860 then today), crew photos, trucks.
- **Guides:** clean reading layout, 68 character line length, a sticky table of contents on desktop, one inline quote CTA mid-article and one at the end.
- **Quote:** 3-step form with the progress route line, big tap targets, instant estimate at each step, "BOOKED IN" stamp on success.
- **404:** a lost camel in the desert with a "Take me home" button. One small moment of humour.

Guardrails

Animations that slow the page down will cost rankings and calls, so these limits are hard rules, not suggestions.

Performance budgets (mobile, 4G)

Metric	Budget
LCP (hero photo)	under 2.5 s
CLS	under 0.1
INP	under 200 ms
JS for animation (Motion + GSAP)	under 60 KB gzipped, loaded only on pages that use it
Hero image	under 180 KB AVIF, <code>priority</code> , correct <code>sizes</code>
Fonts	2 families max, self-hosted, subset, <code>font-display: swap</code>
Lighthouse mobile	90+ performance, 100 accessibility, 100 SEO

Rules

- Animate only `transform`, `opacity`, `clip-path` and `stroke-dashoffset`. Never animate width, height, top or left.
- Nothing animates before the hero headline, phone number and quote button are visible and clickable.
- Every effect respects `prefers-reduced-motion`.
- Route line and truck are `aria-hidden`; they are decoration.
- Colour contrast AA minimum; terracotta on sand must be checked for small text.
- Keep the pages statically rendered from the SEO report. Animations run client-side only in small client components, not whole pages.
- Test on a real mid-range Android phone, not just a MacBook.

Anti-slop checklist (run before shipping)

- ☐ Every photo on the site is real and theirs.
- ☐ No section repeats a point another section already made.
- ☐ No identical 3-card icon grids anywhere.
- ☐ Headline could only belong to Vic Cameleers.
- ☐ "No surprises" appears once, max.

- ☐ No banned words: seamless, hassle-free, stress-free, elevate, unlock, tailored, look no further.
- ☐ No em dashes in copy.
- ☐ Every animation has a reason tied to the route, the stamp, or the price.
- ☐ A stranger can find the price and the phone number within 3 seconds on a phone.

Master Claude Code prompt

Paste this into Claude Code in the repo, after the SEO prompt (Prompt 1 on the main tab) is merged and real photos are in `/public/photos/`. It replaces Prompt 2 on the main tab and names each skill so Claude Code loads it at the right step.

You are redesigning the Vic Cameleers website (Next.js App Router, Tailwind, shadcn/ui, hosted on Vercel) into a standout, award-quality local business site with purposeful motion. Vic Cameleers is a removalist crew based in Cranbourne VIC serving Greater Melbourne, Victoria only. \$120/hour, 2 hour minimum, 45 minute call-out. Fleet: 6 tonne truck (2 movers) and 10 tonne truck (3-4 movers). Phone 0481 950 085.

Creative concept: "The Caravan Route". In 1860 camels and cameleers landed at Port Melbourne to haul supplies for the Burke and Wills expedition. The site is one journey: a dotted caravan route line starts at the hero, draws itself down the page on scroll past each section (each section is a "stop"), with a small truck riding along it, and ends at the quote button. Look: outback freight meets modern Melbourne (sand, kraft cardboard, terracotta, deep navy, stencilled crate lettering, freight labels, real photos). Feel: heavy things moving smoothly. Weighted, deliberate, never bouncy.

Three signature moments, everything else stays calm:

1. Hero: real truck photo with slow parallax, headline words stamping in like a rubber freight stamp, live price calculator visible in the first mobile screen.
2. The scroll-drawn route line with a truck riding it.
3. Odometer-style rolling digits on every price.

Real photos are in `/public/photos/`: [LIST FILES]. Use only these for trucks, crew and jobs. Never stock, never AI-generated people or vehicles.

WORK IN PHASES. Stop after each phase, show me screenshots and a summary, and wait for my OK.

PHASE 0: Understand (use learn-codebase, smart-explore, mem-search)

- Map routes, layout, components, Tailwind config, fonts, the CSP/nonce middleware, the admin route, the quote form (Resend, Turnstile, Upstash). List anything the redesign must not break.
- Use agent-browser to screenshot every page at 390px and 1440px as "before" images.

PHASE 1: Audit (use design-is)

- Run a Dieter Rams style audit of the current site. List what is useless, repeated, decorative or generic. Known issues: zero images, duplicated "How it works" + "From booking to moving day", duplicated "difference" + "Why people choose us", identical icon-card grids with hover lift, 01-04 step badges, Oswald + Inter, overused "no surprises".

PHASE 2: Direction and brand (use redesign-existing-projects as the lead process, high-end-visual-design + design-taste-frontend as the lead aesthetic, industrial-brutalist-ui for accents only, then brandkit)

- Produce a one-page design brief: 3 font pairings (slab/stencil display + Barlow or Public Sans body) with a recommendation, final colour tokens (sand-50 #faf7f0, sand-100 #f5efdd, kraft-300 #c9a878, terracotta-500 #d5673f, terracotta-700 #c1502e, navy-800 #1b3a5c, navy-950 #0b1b2e, ink-900 #232323, signal-400 #f99c00 for tiny accents), 70/20/10 usage rule, type scale with clamp(), spacing, 4px radius, 2px navy borders instead of soft shadows, grain texture spec, photo grading and duotone rules, icon style.
- Use imagegen-frontend-web ONLY for: the grain texture, the route line styling, a stylised south-east Melbourne map, freight stamp graphics, and an archival-style 1860 illustration. Nothing that shows the trucks, crew or customers.
- Implement tokens in Tailwind config and CSS variables with light mode as default and a dark navy variant for dark sections.

PHASE 3: Motion system (use design-motion-principles)

- Install `motion` and `gsap` (with ScrollTrigger and MotionPathPlugin). Bundle locally, keep the existing CSP working.
- Create motion tokens: ease-haul cubic-bezier(0.22,1,0.36,1), ease-route cubic-bezier(0.65,0,0.35,1), ease-stamp spring (stiffness 500, damping 30), durations 150/400/700 ms, 60 ms stagger (max 6 items), travel distance 16-24px.
- Build reusable client components: <Reveal>, <StampText>, <Odometer>, <RouteLine>, <ClipReveal> (no magnetic buttons). Each must honour prefers-reduced-motion with a static fallback.
- Effects list to implement exactly: hero photo fade + 1.04 to 1 settle; headline word stamp; hero parallax at 0.85x; odometer digits in the

calculator; 6t/10t badge morph via layoutId; header transparent to solid + 80 to 64px shrink after 80px scroll; GSAP scroll-scrubbed route line (stroke-dashoffset) with truck riding via MotionPath pausing at section stops; freight-label eyebrows slide 16px with border draw; service photos roller-door clip-path reveal with text 100ms after; crew duotone to colour on hover/focus; fleet "what fits" icons loading into a truck outline; map pins stagger; buttons press 0.97 and a subtle hazard-stripe shimmer on the primary CTA hover; FAQ height animation; quote form horizontal steps with progress route and a "BOOKED IN" stamp on success; page transitions via View Transitions API if the installed Next/React version supports it, otherwise AnimatePresence cross-fade; mobile action bar slides up after the hero and hides at the footer.

- Banned: custom cursors, scroll-jacking, particles, typewriter text, 3D tilt, fake logo marquees, confetti, autoplay hero video on mobile.

PHASE 4: Plan (use make-plan)

- Turn phases 5-7 into a numbered task list with files touched and a checkpoint after each group.

PHASE 5: Build (use do + full-output-enforcement)

- Homepage in this order: (0) hero with overlapping calculator, (1) proof strip, (2) services as alternating photo rows, (3) ONE merged 3-step How it works drawn as route stops, (4) Meet the crew strip with real names, (5) dark navy cameleer story section with archival 1860 treatment, (6) fleet on kraft texture with what-fits diagrams, (7) stylised south-east map with suburb chips, (8) FAQ + final quote panel where the route ends.
- Then: pricing (full-width calculator + real invoice example), service pages, suburb pages (drive-time freight label, local photo if present, recent job card, nearby suburb mini-map), about (editorial timeline 1860 to today), guides (68ch reading width, sticky TOC on desktop, inline CTA), quote (3 steps, progress route, BOOKED IN stamp), 404 (lost camel, "Take me home").
- Write complete files. No "rest unchanged" placeholders.

PHASE 6: Polish (use impeccable)

- Pixel pass on spacing, alignment, optical sizes, hover/focus/active/disabled states, empty and error states, dark sections, every breakpoint from 360px to 1920px.

PHASE 7: Test (use run + agent-browser)

- Run locally, screenshot every page at 390px and 1440px as "after", place side by side with "before".
- Lighthouse mobile on home, pricing, one service, one suburb, quote.

Budgets: LCP < 2.5s, CLS < 0.1, INP < 200ms, performance 90+, accessibility

100, SEO 100. Animation JS under 60KB gzipped and only on pages that use it. Hero image under 180KB AVIF with priority.

- Test with prefers-reduced-motion on. Test keyboard-only navigation.

PHASE 8: Ship (use simplify, code-review, security-review, then babysit)

- Remove unused components, CSS and dependencies.
- Code review and security review. Confirm: CSP and security headers unchanged or stricter, admin route still protected and noindexed, quote form still validates, rate-limits and emails, no new third-party scripts.
- Push to a preview branch and babysit the Vercel build until green.

Non-negotiable rules

- Keep all SEO metadata, canonical tags, schema and static rendering from the previous work.
- Animate only transform, opacity, clip-path, stroke-dashoffset.
- The phone number, price and quote button are visible and usable before any animation finishes.
- Copy: plain, direct, slightly funny Australian voice, Australian spelling, no em dashes, "no surprises" max once sitewide. Banned words: seamless, hassle-free, stress-free, elevate, unlock, tailored, cutting-edge, look no further, peace of mind, your trusted partner.
- Never invent reviews, ratings, customer names, job counts, awards or years in business.
- Final anti-slop check: every photo real, no repeated points across sections, no identical icon-card grids, headline only this business could say, every animation tied to the route, the stamp or the price.